

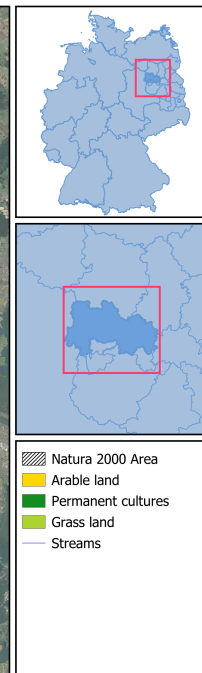
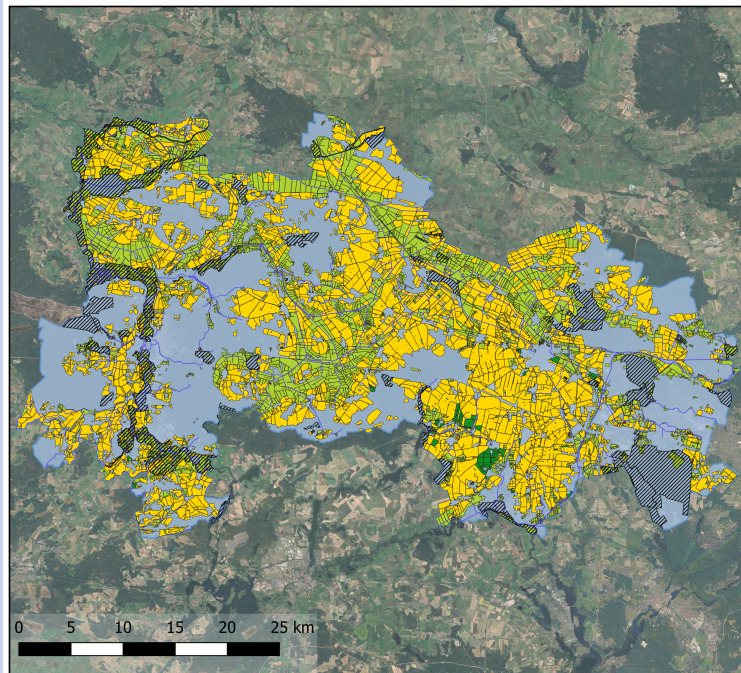
Fact Sheet: Havelland

Name of living lab

Contact: Sebastian Rogga (sebastian.rogga@zalf.de)

Name and email

Please add GIS map here



Soil-climate area (Bodenklimaräume)

Please describe the main characteristics regarding the geo-physical conditions from perspective of agriculture (Soil types and conditions for agriculture; Climate conditions; Geographic characteristics)

The Havelland district lies west of Berlin and borders Saxony-Anhalt to the west. Extensive glacial valleys dominate the landscape in Havelland. Plateaus rise up like islands (e.g. the Nauener Plateau, Glindower Plateau), most of which are covered by ground moraines. The plateaus have higher soil quality than the lowlands and are used intensively for agriculture. Extensive meadows in the lowlands contrast with arable land and forests in the highlands (known as 'Ländchen'). These 'Luch landscapes' are largely drained. The mosaic-like juxtaposition of island-like plateaus and extensive lowlands characterises this natural area. The mostly gently undulating islands stand out clearly from the surrounding lowlands.

The Havelland district is still considered part of the North-East German lowlands, with influences of maritime climates. Summers are relatively warm, and summer precipitation levels of 250-350 mm are slightly higher than during the rest of the year. In winter, which can be considered mild to moderately cold on average, there are more days with precipitation than in summer, but with lower total precipitation levels. Due to increasing evaporation, the climatic water balance in the area under consideration is generally deteriorating. This is particularly evident in summer and is a development that will become increasingly significant in the future. Havelland is classified as part of the North German inland lowlands (soil climate zone 102) and has sandy, diluvial soils. The quality of the arable soil increases from west to east. The average soil quality rating for agricultural land is 35.9.

Key challenges (Please describe the key challenges related to soil climate area)

- Dramatic increase in heat stress (cf. Lüttger et al. 2011: Klimawandel in der Region Havelland)
- Significant increase in evaporation during the summer months worsens the climatic water balance (ibid.)

Soil-climate information

Main soil types:	sandy diluvial
Topography:	mostly flat
Site altitude (m):	30-50 m asl.
Average rainfall (mm/year):	595
Average temperature:	8,9 °C (1977-2006)
potential evaporation	615,4 mm/yr
avg. soil qual. rate (Bodenkennzahl)	35,9

Justification for living lab delineation

The Havelland region is both a landscape and cultural area with a distinct identity and an administrative district. This makes it easier to run policy labs, as there are usually not several entities involved.

Agricultural production system
Please describe the main characteristics regarding agricultural production systems: 00 farms operate on almost 90,000 hectares of agricultural land (equals an average farm size of ~ 180 ha). Over 80% of agricultural land is farmed by businesses, who own more than 100 ha farmland each. Small businesses account for just 3.6% of the area. One third of the total agricultural area is grassland, two thirds is arable land. Due to the high proportion of grassland in the region, cattle, horse and sheep farming are particularly important. A wide variety of crops are grown, from rye and barley to maize, potatoes, high-quality wheat and beet. Parts of the Havelländische Luch are also attractive for arable farming due to their proximity to groundwater.
Key challenges (Please describe the key challenges related to the agricultural production system) Agriculture in the Havelland is characterised by location and land conditions (wetlands, predominance of grassland, varying soil quality) and is simultaneously subject to growing external demands (animal welfare, biodiversity, environmental protection, economic efficiency, climate change, and in the east of the region: land use pressure from competing land users). The combination of different uses (arable land, grassland, animal husbandry) and coordination with water/soil/nature conservation associations is complex. Water management requirements clash with outdated water regulation technology.

General information	
Land Area:	1.727 km²
Agriculture:	55,8 %
Forests:	25,6 %
Grassland:	33 %
Fallow land:	1,3 %
Protected area:	ca. 7,5 %
Organic agriculture:	15,86 %
Main crop types:	grains, oilseeds
Main livestock:	cattle, horse, sheep
Average farm size:	~180ha
Average rent rate:	-

Socio-economic conditions
Please describe the main characteristics regarding the socio-cultural conditions: The socio-economic situation of the Havelland region is strongly influenced by its proximity to Berlin, with the eastern part of the region, which is close to the city, differing significantly from the rural western part. The population and building density is much higher in the east. The towns of Falkensee and Nauen, which are close to Berlin, have grown rapidly in recent years, and the district is among the top 15 in Germany in terms of positive net migration. Most industrial companies (especially in the logistics sector) are also located in the east of the district. The importance of tourism (especially water tourism) has increased recently. At 6.1%, the unemployment rate is relatively low compared to the rest of the state. However, household incomes are among the lowest in Germany.
Key challenges (Please describe the key challenges related to socio-cultural conditions) - Decline in rural population <---> strong growth and competition for land use near Berlin - Below-average household incomes - Concentration and thinning out of the retail sector - Potential for direct marketing in agriculture not yet exploited - Cross-regional networks could be expanded

General information	
Population: (inhabitants)	169.334
Population density: (inhabitants/km²):	98
Next city:	Berlin
GDP/Capita:	22.686 €
Average annual household income: (€)	-
NUTS 3 codes:	DE406

Key stakeholders (organisations / institutions)
Kreisbauernverband Havelland (KBV) e.V. (regional farmers association) ; Lokale Aktionsgruppe (LAG) e.V.; Regionale Planungsgemeinschaft Havelland-Fläming (regional planning authority); Umweltamt (environmental agency); Untere Naturschutzbehörde (lower nature conservation authority), Untere Wasserbehörde (lower water authority); Amt für Landwirtschaft, veterinär- und Lebensmittelüberwachung (Office for Agriculture, Veterinary and Food Monitoring); AbL Landesverband NordOst; Sielmann Naturlandschaft Döberitzer Heide gGmbH; Unterer Naturpark Westhavelland

Ongoing research (topics)
FiNAL - investigates how diversity, biomass and functionality of insects can be enhanced in agricultural landscapes WetNet BB - researches the synergy potential of peatlands for climate, water, soil and biodiversity protection as well as for regional value creation F.R.A.N.Z. - develops efficient nature conservation measures and management concepts for biological diversity CLEAR - explore landscape-level collaborative planning approaches for improved agrobiodiversity and resilience